

Koko the Parrot Learns to Listen

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Koko was a bright green parrot. She lived in the tallest kapok tree. Koko loved to talk. She repeated everything she heard. "Hello!" said the toucan. "Hello!" said Koko. "Beautiful day!" said the monkey. "Beautiful day!" said Koko. Koko was very good at repeating. But she was not very good at listening. One morning, her friend Taro the tapir came by. Taro looked sad. His ears drooped. "I lost my favorite leaf blanket," said Taro. "It kept me warm." Koko flapped her wings. "Lost my favorite leaf blanket!" she squawked. "It kept me warm!" Taro sighed. He tried again. "It was red and gold." "Red and gold!" said Koko. Taro felt unheard. He felt sadder. He walked away slowly.



Koko felt confused. "Why did Taro leave?" she asked the wind. The old tortoise, Grandpa Shell, heard her. He spoke slowly and wisely. "Koko, you repeat, but you do not listen," he said. "Taro needed a friend, not an echo." Koko felt ashamed. Her feathers drooped. "I did not know," she whispered. Grandpa Shell nodded. "Then learn this," he said. "Listening is a gift too." "Listening is a gift too." Koko repeated it softly. "Listening is a gift too." It became her quiet lesson. "Listening is a gift too."



Koko flew after Taro. She found him by the stream. This time, Koko closed her beak. She opened her ears instead. "Tell me about your blanket," she said softly. And she listened. Taro talked about the red leaf. He talked about the gold leaf. He talked about how cozy it was. Koko did not repeat a single word. She just listened. Taro felt heard. He felt better. A small smile came back. "Thank you for listening," said Taro. Koko felt warm. She felt proud. Listening was a gift too.



Can you listen like Koko? Close your mouth. Open your ears. Listen for three quiet sounds. One... two... three. Good listening! Then Koko had an idea. "Let us make you a new blanket," she said. They gathered red leaves. They gathered gold leaves. They wove them together. Pat pat pat. Taro wrapped up cozy. "Perfect!" he said. Koko smiled. She had listened, and then she had helped.



That night, the jungle grew quiet. Koko perched on her branch. Taro slept below, wrapped in his new blanket. "Goodnight, good listener," whispered Taro. "Goodnight," said Koko softly. She did not repeat it. She just meant it. The leaves rustled gently. The moon peeked through the trees. And Koko slept, peaceful and quiet.

Moral: *Listening closely is one of the kindest gifts you can give.*

The End